Bowdoin CDS Data Dictionary

Source: Common Data Set (CDS) forms, Bowdoin College, 2001-2025.

Identifiers

Column	Description
`year`	Academic year start (e.g., 2001 = 2001-2002 CDS)
`source_file`	PDF filename the data was drawn from

Applications, Admissions & Enrollment

Column	Description
`apps_men`	Number of male applicants
`apps_women`	Number of female applicants
`total_apps`	Total number of applicants
`admits_men`	Number of male applicants admitted
`admits_women`	Number of female applicants admitted
`total_admits`	Total number of applicants admitted
`enrolled_men`	Number of male students who enrolled
`enrolled_women`	Number of female students who enrolled
`total_enrolled`	Total first-year students enrolled
`accept_rate`	Acceptance rate (%) - total_admits / total_apps
`yield_rate`	Yield rate (%) - total_enrolled / total_admits
`total_undergrad`	Total undergraduate enrollment (all years, not just first-year)

Outcomes

Column	Description
`retention_rate`	First-to-second year retention rate (%) - missing 2020-2023
`grad_rate_6yr`	6-year graduation rate (%) - missing 2017-2024

Early Decision

Column	Description
`ed_apps`	Number of Early Decision applicants
`ed_admits`	Number of Early Decision admits

Geographic Breakdown (first-year enrolled)

Only available for 2023-2025; not reported in earlier CDS forms.

Column	Description
`apps_instate`	Applications from in-state students
`apps_outofstate`	Applications from out-of-state (domestic) students
`apps_intl`	Applications from international students
`admits_instate`	Admits who are in-state
`admits_outofstate`	Admits who are out-of-state (domestic)
`admits_intl`	Admits who are international
`enrolled_instate`	Enrolled first-year students from in-state
`enrolled_outofstate`	Enrolled first-year students from out-of-state (domestic)
`enrolled_intl`	Enrolled first-year students who are international

Enrolled Student Race/Ethnicity

Counts of enrolled undergraduates by race/ethnicity. Note: `enroll_nhpi` and `enroll_two_or_more` are missing 2001-2009 as these categories were not yet tracked.

Column	Description
`enroll_hispanic`	Hispanic/Latino students enrolled
`enroll_black`	Black or African American students enrolled
`enroll_white`	White students enrolled
`enroll_aian`	American Indian or Alaska Native students enrolled
`enroll_asian`	Asian students enrolled
`enroll_nhpi`	Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander students enrolled - missing 2001-2009
`enroll_two_or_more`	Students of two or more races enrolled - missing 2001-2009
`enroll_unknown`	Race/ethnicity unknown or not reported

Degrees Conferred - Bachelor's (% of total)

Percentage of bachelor's degrees awarded in each CIP discipline area. Based on majors, not headcount (double majors counted twice). History was bundled into Social Sciences for 2001-2004, so `deg_pct_history` is blank for those years.

Column	Description
`deg_pct_area_ethnic_studies`	Area, ethnic, and gender studies
`deg_pct_biological_life_sciences`	Biological and life sciences
`deg_pct_computer_info_sciences`	Computer and information sciences
`deg_pct_english`	English language and literature
`deg_pct_foreign_languages`	Foreign languages, literatures, and linguistics
`deg_pct_history`	History - blank 2001-2004 (included in social sciences)
`deg_pct_interdisciplinary`	Interdisciplinary studies
`deg_pct_mathematics`	Mathematics and statistics
`deg_pct_natural_resources`	Natural resources and conservation
`deg_pct_philosophy_religion`	Philosophy and religious studies
`deg_pct_physical_sciences`	Physical sciences
`deg_pct_psychology`	Psychology
`deg_pct_social_sciences`	Social sciences - includes history for 2001-2004
`deg_pct_visual_performing_arts`	Visual and performing arts

Degrees Conferred - Other

Column	Description
`deg_diploma_pct_education`	Education - reported as diploma/certificate (teacher certification) in early years, bachelor's in later years; blank where not reported
`deg_total_graduates`	Total number of graduates - only available for 2001 (429) and 2002 (404), drawn from CDS footnotes